

In 1971 there were 135 urban areas of which 12 were Municipal Council areas, 37 Urban Council areas and 86 Town Council areas. Of the total urban population of 2,848,116 about 42 percent or 1,219,682 were in the Municipal areas, 28 percent or 771,095 were in the urban areas, and 30 percent or 857,339 were in the Town Council areas. There were three Municipal Council areas, each with a population exceeding 100,000. Colombo M.C. had the highest population of 562,420. No Urban Council had a population of over 100,000 and no Town Council had a population of over 50,000. Table 3.9 summarises the distribution of population by type of local area in 1963 and 1971.

TABLE 3.9 : TOTAL POPULATION BY TYPE OF URBAN AREA - 1963 AND 1971

Type	1963			1971		
	No.	Population	Percentage	No.	Population	Percentage
Municipal Councils	10	1,031,557	51.2	12	1,219,682	42.8
Urban Councils	35	581,279	28.8	37	771,095	27.1
Town Councils	54	403,449	20.0	86	857,339	30.1
Total	99	2,016,285	100.0	135	2,848,116	100.0

The Municipal Council's share of the total urban population has declined from 51.2 percent in 1963 to 42.8 percent in 1971 despite the increases in the number of municipal councils from 10 to 12. The Urban Council's share shows only a slight decline while the Town Council's share shows the highest increase from 20.0 percent in 1963 to 30.1 percent in 1971. This is largely due, as stated earlier, to the increase in the number of Town Council areas from 54 in 1963 to 86 in 1971.

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TOTAL

Popu
tic

115,
215,
499,
781,
411,
823,
2848,